

Top vision

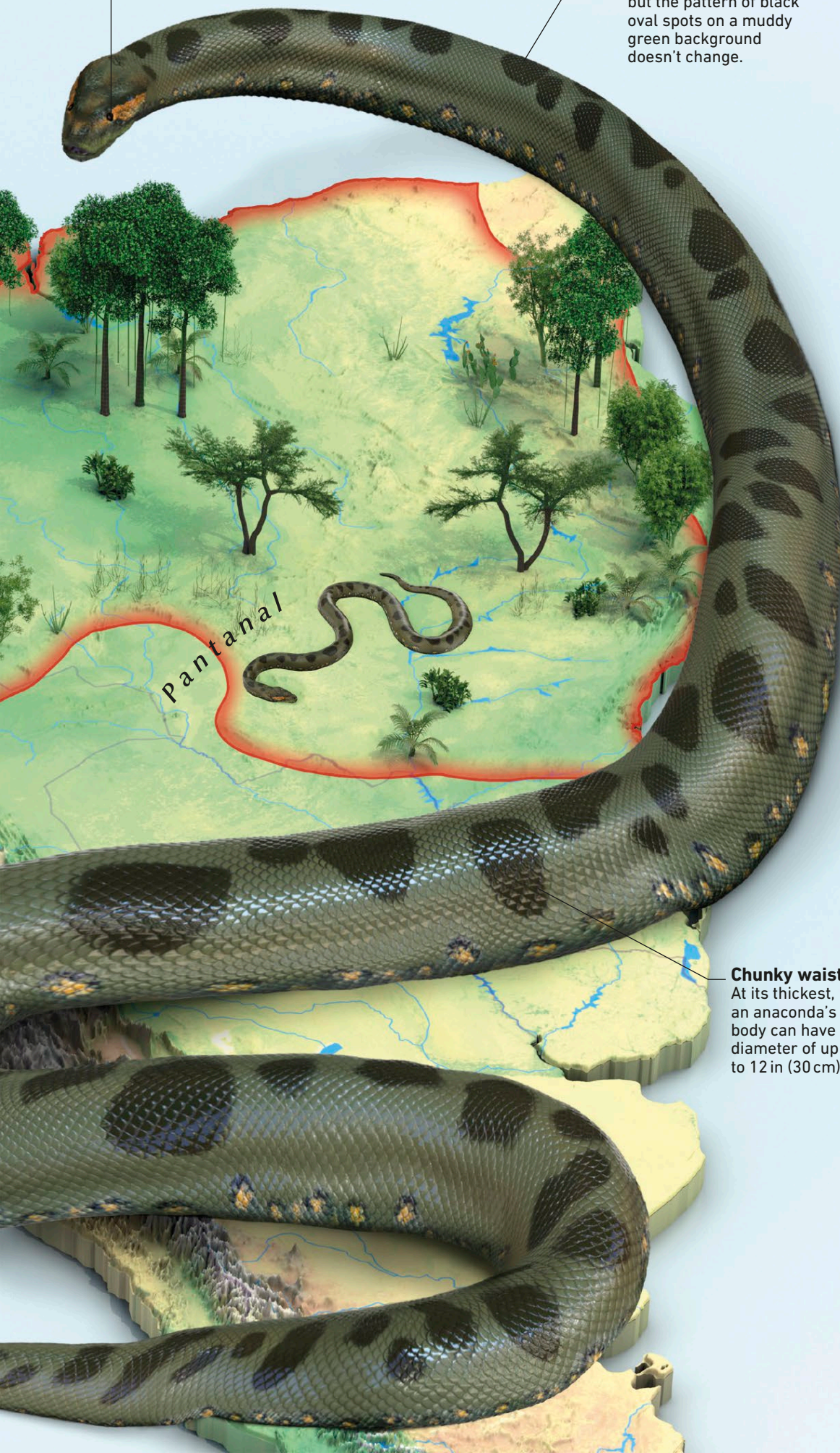
The eyes of a green anaconda are set higher on the head than those of many other snakes. This helps it keep watch at the water's surface, while its body is submerged.

Scaly skin

As it grows, the anaconda needs to shed its scaly skin several times a year, but the pattern of black oval spots on a muddy green background doesn't change.

Chunky waist

At its thickest, an anaconda's body can have a diameter of up to 12 in (30 cm).



OTHER LARGE CONSTRUCTORS



Reticulated python

The green anaconda is the heaviest, but the longest snake is likely to be the reticulated python from Southeast Asia, with recorded lengths of more than 23 ft (7 m).



African rock python

The biggest snake in Africa, growing to 20 ft (6 m) long, the African rock python has the strength to prey on large crocodiles.



Burmese python

Weighing around 400 lb (180 kg), the Burmese python from Southeast Asia is the heaviest recorded snake after the green anaconda.



Indian rock python

Only slightly smaller than the Burmese and African rock pythons, this snake swims well and is common in wetlands and forests of India and Sri Lanka.



Amethystine python

Australia's largest snake hunts possums and wallabies, and sometimes slides into human homes. It is also widespread in New Guinea and nearby islands.

